MODULE 10

Tell a Tale

"Language grows out of life, out of its needs and experiences."

— ANNE SULLIVAN

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

Why is it important to pass stories down to the next generation?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**When the Giant Stirred**	· Celia Godkin	LEGEND
2	**Why the Sky Is Far Away**	· retold by Marci Stillerman	FOLKTALE
3	**Cinder Al and the Stinky Footwear**	· Roger Lore	FAIRY TALE
4	**Compay Mono and Comay Jicotea**	· retold by Joe Hayes	FOLKTALE

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B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 12

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 10 · Tell a Tale · Grade 3 · 23 Items

CCSS L.3.4 · L.3.5 · L.3.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.3.6

myth

A **myth** is —

- ◯ **A.** a list of true facts about a country.
- ◯ **B.** a letter written to a friend.
- ◯ **C.** a well-known story about fantastical events that happened in the past.
- ◯ **D.** a song people sing at a party.

Q2 L.3.6

folklore

Folklore is —

- ◯ **A.** the traditional sayings, beliefs, and stories within a community.
- ◯ **B.** a map of a town's streets.
- ◯ **C.** a set of rules for a game.
- ◯ **D.** a kind of weather that comes in winter.

Q3 L.3.5 TRAP

recount

If you **recount** a story or events, you —

- ◯ **A.** count the same numbers over again.
- ◯ **B.** tell about something you have read or seen.
- ◯ **C.** keep it a secret from everyone.
- ◯ **D.** add up money in a drawer.

Q4 L.3.6

inherit

When you **inherit** something, it is —

- ◯ **A.** bought by you at a store.
- ◯ **B.** thrown away because it is old.
- ◯ **C.** made by you out of new parts.
- ◯ **D.** given to you, usually by a parent or grandparent.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WHEN THE GIANT STIRRED

Q5 L.3.4

lagoon

The island had a cool, blue **lagoon**. A **lagoon** is —

- ◯ **A.** an area of seawater that is separated from the ocean by rocks or sand.
- ◯ **B.** a tall mountain that smokes.
- ◯ **C.** a thick, green forest.
- ◯ **D.** a wide, dry desert.

Q6 L.3.4

garlands

The people carried **garlands** up the mountain. **Garlands** are —

- ◯ **A.** baskets full of fish.
- ◯ **B.** small wooden boats.
- ◯ **C.** ropes made of flowers or leaves.
- ◯ **D.** heavy stones from the beach.

Q7 L.3.5 TRAP

belched

The volcano **belched** out black smoke. If a volcano **belched**, it —

- ◯ **A.** made a small burp after a meal.
- ◯ **B.** stayed completely quiet and cold.
- ◯ **C.** slowly cooled down overnight.
- ◯ **D.** suddenly pushed out a large amount of smoke or fire.

Q8 L.3.4

cinders

A rain of **cinders** fell on the village. **Cinders** are —

- ◯ **A.** drops of cool rain.
- ◯ **B.** small black pieces of ash that are left after a fire has burned.
- ◯ **C.** bright green leaves.
- ◯ **D.** shiny gold coins.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WHEN THE GIANT STIRRED (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.3.5 TRAP

appease

No flowers could **appease** the mountain god. If you **appease** someone, you —

- ◯ **A.** try to make the person less angry by giving in to what he or she wants.
- ◯ **B.** make the person even angrier on purpose.
- ◯ **C.** run away and hide from the person.
- ◯ **D.** ask the person to leave forever.

Q10 L.3.4

barren

For months the island was a **barren**, black rock. If an area of land is **barren**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** full of tall trees and flowers.
- ◯ **B.** covered with deep snow.
- ◯ **C.** dry and cannot grow plants or trees.
- ◯ **D.** crowded with many animals.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · WHY THE SKY IS FAR AWAY

Q11 L.3.4

tempting

The food looked **tempting** and inviting. If something is **tempting**, it is —

- ◯ **A.** something you are afraid of.
- ◯ **B.** something you want very much.
- ◯ **C.** something that is broken.
- ◯ **D.** something that is far away.

Q12 L.3.4

quantities

The people pulled down great **quantities** of the sky. **Quantities** are —

- **A.** amounts that can be counted.
- **B.** kinds of music.
- **C.** colors of the rainbow.
- **D.** names of the days.

Q13 L.3.5 TRAP

ominously

The sky grew **ominously** dark. If something acts **ominously**, it —

- **A.** moves in a slow, sleepy way.
- **B.** makes a soft, happy sound.
- **C.** smells sweet like flowers.
- **D.** makes you think that something bad might happen.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · CINDER AL AND THE STINKY FOOTWEAR

Q14 L.3.4

upcoming

The princess had no one to dance with at the **upcoming** Palace Ball. If an event is **upcoming**, it —

- **A.** happened a long time ago.
- **B.** will take place soon.
- **C.** was canceled and will not happen.
- **D.** is happening up on a high hill.

Q15 L.3.4

proclamation

Princess Peeyu issued a royal **proclamation**. A **proclamation** is —

- **A.** a quiet whisper to one friend.
- **B.** a pair of fancy dancing shoes.
- **C.** a statement or message about an important matter that everyone needs to know.
- **D.** a secret that no one is allowed to share.

Q16 L.3.5 TRAP

pungent

The footwear had a **pungent** odor. If something is **pungent**, it —

- ◯ **A.** has a strong smell that may be unpleasant.
- ◯ **B.** has a sharp point at the end.
- ◯ **C.** is small enough to fit in a pocket.
- ◯ **D.** is soft and easy to bend.

Q17 L.3.4

snickered

Al's brothers **snickered** at him. If someone **snickered**, they —

- ◯ **A.** cried very loudly.
- ◯ **B.** cheered with joy.
- ◯ **C.** spoke in a kind voice.
- ◯ **D.** laughed in a rude or disrespectful way.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · COMPAY MONO AND COMAY JICOTEA

Q18 L.3.4

theft

Compay Mono was upset about the **theft** of his crops. **Theft** is —

- ◯ **A.** the act of growing new plants.
- ◯ **B.** the act of taking something that belongs to someone else.
- ◯ **C.** the act of sharing food with a friend.
- ◯ **D.** the act of building a small house.

Q19 L.3.4

inspected

Compay Mono **inspected** his whole farm. If you **inspected** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** threw it away quickly.
- ◯ **B.** gave it to a neighbor.
- ◯ **C.** checked it very carefully.
- ◯ **D.** hid it under the ground.

Q20 L.3.4

sympathetic

Comay Jicotea pretended to be **sympathetic**. When you are **sympathetic** to someone, you are —

- **A.** kind and understanding about his or her situation.
- **B.** angry and unfriendly toward the person.
- **C.** bored and not listening at all.
- **D.** afraid of being near the person.

Q21 L.3.4

suspicious

Compay Mono began to get **suspicious**. If you are **suspicious** of someone, you are —

- **A.** completely sure they are honest.
- **B.** proud of everything they do.
- **C.** excited to give them a gift.
- **D.** untrusting of that person.

Q22 L.3.4

reputation

Comay Jicotea had a **reputation** for being tricky. If you have a **reputation** for something, others —

- **A.** have never heard of you at all.
- **B.** know or remember you for that thing.
- **C.** forget about you right away.
- **D.** ask you to keep it a secret.

Q23 L.3.5 TRAP

crafty

That **crafty** Jicotea fooled Compay Mono. Someone who is **crafty** —

- **A.** is very good at making art and crafts.
- **B.** is gentle and always honest.
- **C.** uses clever or tricky ways to get what he or she wants.
- **D.** is slow and easily fooled.

Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 10 · Tell a Tale · Grade 3 · 32 Items

CCSS RL.3.1 · RL.3.2 · RL.3.3 · RL.3.5 · RL.3.6 · RI.3.1 · RI.3.2 · RI.3.3

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · When the Giant Stirred

LEGEND · CELIA GODKIN · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RL.3.2

What is this legend mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to sail a boat across the sea.
- ◯ **B.** A peaceful island whose mountain erupts, and how life slowly returns afterward.
- ◯ **C.** How sea turtles lay their eggs in the sand.
- ◯ **D.** How to build a house out of grass.

Q2 RL.3.3

How did the island people treat the mountain before it erupted?

- ◯ **A.** They tried to climb to the very top of it.
- ◯ **B.** They built their houses inside its crater.
- ◯ **C.** They treated it like a god and brought garlands of flowers to please it.
- ◯ **D.** They paid no attention to it at all.

Q3 RL.3.3

Why did the chief tell the people it was time to leave the island?

- ◯ **A.** When the birds left, he knew the mountain would awake in anger and no flowers could stop it.
- ◯ **B.** The people had run out of food to eat.
- ◯ **C.** A new chief had ordered everyone to move.
- ◯ **D.** They wanted to find a bigger island with more people.

Q4 RL.3.1

What happened to the old island after the volcano erupted?

- **A.** It became even greener than before, right away.
- **B.** It floated away across the sea.
- **C.** It turned into a town full of people.
- **D.** It became a barren, black rock where no living creature had survived.

Q5 RL.3.3

How does life come back to the island over time?

- **A.** Little by little — fish, then plants, then turtles, butterflies, and birds return.
- **B.** All the plants and animals appear again in a single day.
- **C.** The people row back and plant new forests.
- **D.** Nothing ever grows on the island again.

Q6 RL.3.6

The author writes that the mountain "rumbled like a giant mumbling in his sleep." Why does the author write it this way?

- **A.** To prove that a real giant lives inside the mountain.
- **B.** To explain how mountains are formed.
- **C.** To compare the mountain to a sleeping giant, giving a clue that it could be loud and dangerous.
- **D.** To show that the mountain is small and gentle.

Q7 RL.3.5

The author repeats the phrase "On the island" at the start of several stanzas. How does this repetition help the reader?

- **A.** It lists the price of each part of the island.
- **B.** It points to each beautiful place on the island and shows that the setting is important.
- **C.** It tells the reader how to get to the island.
- **D.** It names all the people who live there.

Q8 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN message, or theme, of "When the Giant Stirred"?

- **A.** Great sea turtles come by moonlight to bury their eggs on the white, sandy beaches of the island.
- **B.** When the giant stirred, the mountain belched out black smoke and rained cinders down on the village.
- **C.** The people gathered their belongings, loaded the boats, and paddled away to find a new island home.
- **D.** All things in nature move in an endless cycle of destruction and renewal, and legends help explain it.

Selection 2 · Why the Sky Is Far Away

FOLKTALE · RETOLD BY MARCI STILLERMAN / SALIM BUSURU · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RL.3.2

What is "Why the Sky Is Far Away" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How greedy, wasteful people lost the gift of the sky and had to work for food.
- ◯ **B.** How a king built a brand-new palace.
- ◯ **C.** How to cook a great feast for a festival.
- ◯ **D.** How birds learn to fly high in the air.

Q10 RL.3.3

In the beginning, how did the people get their food?

- ◯ **A.** They hunted animals in the forest all day.
- ◯ **B.** They cut away a piece of the sky to eat, and it tasted like anything they wished.
- ◯ **C.** They bought it at a market in the city.
- ◯ **D.** They grew it in large gardens.

Q11 RL.3.3

Why did the sky first send a warning to King Oba?

- ◯ **A.** The king had forgotten to hold the yearly festival.
- ◯ **B.** The people were too quiet and never sang.
- ◯ **C.** The people had begun to waste food and throw it on the garbage heap.
- ◯ **D.** The king had moved away from the kingdom.

Q12 RL.3.3

What happened at the festival that made the sky finally take its food away?

- ◯ **A.** The people grew greedy again, pulled down great quantities of sky, and threw what they could not eat onto the garbage heap.
- ◯ **B.** The people forgot to invite the king.
- ◯ **C.** The people stopped dancing too early.
- ◯ **D.** The people gave all their food away to strangers.

Q13 RL.3.3

What did the sky say the people would have to do once it stopped giving them food?

- ◯ **A.** Move to a new kingdom far away.
- ◯ **B.** Sing songs to bring the sky back down.
- ◯ **C.** Wait quietly for the sky to change its mind.
- ◯ **D.** Work to eat from then on.

Q14 RL.3.6

The author makes the sky talk, boom, and grow dark with anger. Why does the author give the sky these human qualities?

- ◯ **A.** To teach readers the names of the clouds.
- ◯ **B.** To make the sky act like a living character, so readers feel its power and anger.
- ◯ **C.** To prove that the sky is made of food.
- ◯ **D.** To show that the sky is friendly and gentle.

Q15 RL.3.5

Like many folktales, this story is told in order from beginning to end. How does this help the reader?

- ◯ **A.** It hides what happens until the very last line.
- ◯ **B.** It lists facts about the weather in Nigeria.
- ◯ **C.** It lets the reader follow the warnings, the people's choices, and the result step by step.
- ◯ **D.** It tells the ending first and then the beginning.

Q16 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN lesson, or theme, of "Why the Sky Is Far Away"?

- ◯ **A.** Once every year, King Oba gave a great festival in celebration of his kingdom's greatness.
- ◯ **B.** A piece of the sky could taste like meat, corn, honey, or anything else the people felt like eating.
- ◯ **C.** The people came to the festival in gorgeous robes, and music played while everyone danced.
- ◯ **D.** Respect the resources you are given and take only what you need, because waste has consequences.

Selection 3 · Cinder Al and the Stinky Footwear

FAIRY TALE · ROGER LORE / CHIN KO · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RL.3.2

What is "Cinder Al and the Stinky Footwear" mostly about?

- **A.** How to wrestle a skunk and win.
- **B.** How to grow giant onions and garlic.
- **C.** A funny twist on Cinderella in which clean-loving Cinder Al cleans the stinky footwear and dances with the princess.
- **D.** How a fairy godmother makes a pumpkin coach.

Q18 RL.3.3

How does Al get the nickname "Cinder Al"?

- **A.** He cleaned the fireplace cinders and kept things fresh, but his brothers did not appreciate it and teased him.
- **B.** He was named after his grandfather.
- **C.** He liked to play in the ashes for fun.
- **D.** He won a prize at the Palace Ball.

Q19 RL.3.3

What happened when Stinky Steve and Odoriferous Owen tried on the stinky footwear?

- **A.** They both danced happily with the princess.
- **B.** Steve raced out screaming, and Owen fainted in front of the princess.
- **C.** They cleaned the shoes until they smelled sweet.
- **D.** They threw the shoes into the fire.

Q20 RL.3.3

How does Cinder Al solve the problem of the smell so he can wear the footwear?

- **A.** He asks his brothers to wear the shoes for him.
- **B.** He throws the shoes away and buys new ones.
- **C.** He decides not to go to the ball at all.
- **D.** He clips a clothespin on his nose and gives the shoes a good cleaning until they smell like roses.

Q21 RL.3.6

The author writes the story with a wacky, silly tone. Why does the author tell this fairy tale in such a playful way?

- **A.** To have fun making a new, humorous spin on the well-known Cinderella tale.
- **B.** To teach readers the real history of footwear.
- **C.** To make readers feel sad and serious.
- **D.** To explain how skunks make their smell.

Q22 RL.3.5

How can you tell this story is a fairy tale?

- ◯ **A.** It is a list of true facts about a real place.
- ◯ **B.** It is a letter written by Al to the princess.
- ◯ **C.** It begins "Once upon a time," has royalty, and uses magical, exaggerated events.
- ◯ **D.** It is a poem with no characters at all.

Q23 RL.3.1

How does the story end for Cinder Al and Princess Peeyu?

- ◯ **A.** Al loses the footwear and goes home alone.
- ◯ **B.** Al dances with Princess Peeyu, they hit it off, and everything works out happily ever after.
- ◯ **C.** The princess decides not to hold the ball.
- ◯ **D.** Al's brothers win the dance instead.

Q24 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN message, or theme, of "Cinder Al and the Stinky Footwear"?

- ◯ **A.** Princess Peeyu was a mighty skunk-wrestler who could pin five skunks at one time.
- ◯ **B.** Owen owned the biggest onion farm in the land and grew onions the size of ostriches.
- ◯ **C.** Al polished the floors with lemony oils and washed his clothes with lavender-scented soap.
- ◯ **D.** Familiar tales get retold with playful new twists from one generation to the next.

Selection 4 · Compay Mono and Comay Jicotea

FOLKTALE · RETOLD BY JOE HAYES / LUCIA FRANCO · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.3.2

What is "Compay Mono and Comay Jicotea" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** A monkey and a turtle who play tricks on each other after the turtle steals the monkey's crops.
- ◯ **B.** How to plant pumpkins, yams, and yuca on a farm.
- ◯ **C.** How turtles learn to swim in a river.
- ◯ **D.** How to build a tall loft inside a house.

Q26 RL.3.3

Who turns out to be the thief stealing Compay Mono's crops?

- ◯ **A.** A stranger from another farm.
- ◯ **B.** A flock of hungry birds.
- ◯ **C.** Comay Jicotea, who pretended to be a helpful friend.
- ◯ **D.** Compay Mono himself, by accident.

Q27 RL.3.3

How does Compay Mono trap the thief and catch her?

- **A.** He builds a high fence around the whole farm.
- **B.** He says he will hide his money in the loft, then waits awake and grabs Comay Jicotea when she climbs up for it.
- **C.** He asks his neighbors to guard the fields.
- **D.** He moves all his crops into the river.

Q28 RL.3.3

How does Comay Jicotea trick her way to safety in the end?

- **A.** She promises to return all the food she stole.
- **B.** She hides quietly until the monkey falls asleep.
- **C.** She gives the monkey a basket of gold.
- **D.** She begs not to be thrown into the river, where she really wants to go, and the monkey throws her in.

Q29 RL.3.6

Why does the author have the turtle pretend to be "terrified" of the river?

- **A.** So the monkey will do the opposite of what helps him and toss her exactly where she is safe.
- **B.** To show that turtles cannot swim.
- **C.** To prove that the turtle is sorry for stealing.
- **D.** To explain why monkeys live in trees.

Q30 RI.3.3

The introduction explains the words *compay* and *comay*. What does it tell readers these words mean?

- **A.** They are the names of two villages.
- **B.** They mean "enemy" in Spanish.
- **C.** They are short for *compadre* and *comadre* and often just mean "good friend."
- **D.** They are words for monkey and turtle.

Q31 RL.3.5

This folktale is also a trickster tale. What does that tell you to expect in the story?

- **A.** Characters who play tricks on one another to get what they want.
- **B.** A long list of facts about farming.
- **C.** A true report about real monkeys and turtles.
- **D.** A poem about the seasons of the year.

Q32 RL.3.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN lesson, or theme, of "Compay Mono and Comay Jicotea"?

- A. Compay Mono planted pumpkins in the east and cassava, sweet potatoes, and yams around his farm.
- B. Late in the night, Comay Jicotea slipped through the door and began climbing the ladder to the loft.
- C. Monkeys are afraid of cold water, so the monkey would never dive into the river after the turtle.
- D. If you try to trick others you might get tricked yourself, and it is not wise to steal and lie.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 10 · Tell a Tale · Grade 3

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about why we pass stories down to the next generation. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Change / Causation DOK 3

In **"When the Giant Stirred,"** the island goes through a big CHANGE. Show what the island was like BEFORE the eruption, what the mountain DID, and what slowly happened AFTER.

BEFORE → EVENT → AFTER · WHEN THE GIANT STIRRED

THE ISLAND BEFORE	WHAT THE MOUNTAIN DID	THE ISLAND AFTER

Why is this legend, with its cycle of destruction and renewal, worth passing on to new generations? Explain.

Q2 Ethics / Values DOK 3

In **"Why the Sky Is Far Away,"** the people learn a hard LESSON. Trace THREE steps: how the people acted, the warning they got, and what finally happened.

A FOLKTALE LESSON · WHY THE SKY IS FAR AWAY

STEP 1 · AT FIRST

how did the people treat the sky's gift?

STEP 2 · THE WARNING

what did the sky say?

STEP 3 · THE RESULT

what did the sky finally do?

What lesson does this folktale teach about waste, and why is it important to pass on? Explain.

Q3 Communication / Storytelling DOK 3

In **"Cinder AI and the Stinky Footwear,"** an old tale is RETOLD in a new way. Show what is the SAME as Cinderella, what is DIFFERENT, and why a storyteller might make these changes.

AN OLD TALE MADE NEW · CINDER AL

SAME AS CINDERELLA	DIFFERENT IN THIS VERSION

Why might each generation put a new spin on a classic tale? Why is this fun and worth doing?

Q4 Culture / Heritage DOK 3

Two folktales in this module come from different cultures. Compare HOW **"Why the Sky Is Far Away"** (a Nigerian folktale) and **"Compay Mono and Comay Jicotea"** (a Cuban folktale) each teach a lesson through their characters.

TWO CULTURES · TWO FOLKTALES

WHY THE SKY IS FAR AWAY · NIGERIA

COMPAY MONO AND COMAY JICOTEA · CUBA

What do both folktales show about how cultures use stories to teach lessons? (Hint: two cultures, but both teach how to behave.)

Q5 Culture / Storytelling DOK 4

Essential Question: Why is it important to pass stories down to the next generation? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

Why is THIS story worth passing on (it teaches a lesson, explains the world, shares a culture, or entertains)?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

Why is THIS story worth passing on (it teaches a lesson, explains the world, shares a culture, or entertains)?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 10 · Tell a Tale · Grade 3

MAP RIT 195 → 215 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Spider and the Stories

Long ago, all the world's stories belonged to the Sky God. He kept them locked in a golden box. A small spider named Anansi wished to share the stories with people on earth. So he climbed a thread all the way up to the sky. "I would like to buy your stories," Anansi said. The Sky God laughed. "Many strong people have tried and failed," he said. "You are so small. How could you do it?" But Anansi was clever. With patience and tricks, he completed every hard task the Sky God asked. At last the Sky God kept his word and gave the spider the box of stories. Anansi carried the stories down to earth and shared them with everyone. That is why, in some lands, people call folktales "spider stories." The little spider made sure the tales would be told again and again, far into the future.

149 WORDS · LEXILE 410–460L · RIT 195–201

Q1 RIT 195 | Lexile 410L | Key Detail

Where did the Sky God keep the world's stories?

- ◯ **A.** Locked in a golden box.
- ◯ **B.** Buried under the sea.
- ◯ **C.** Hidden in a deep cave.
- ◯ **D.** Written in a big book.

Q2 RIT 197 | Lexile 420L | Key Detail

What did Anansi want to do with the stories?

- ◯ **A.** Keep them all to himself.
- ◯ **B.** Share them with the people on earth.
- ◯ **C.** Sell them back to the Sky God.
- ◯ **D.** Burn them in a fire.

Q3 RIT 199 | Lexile 440L | Cause & Effect

Why did the Sky God finally give Anansi the box of stories?

- ◯ **A.** Anansi paid him a pile of gold.
- ◯ **B.** The Sky God felt too tired to keep them.
- ◯ **C.** Anansi completed every hard task the Sky God asked.
- ◯ **D.** A storm blew the box down to earth.

Q4 RIT 200 Lexile 450L Vocabulary

The passage says Anansi was "clever." A **clever** person is —

- ◯ **A.** very large and strong.
- ◯ **B.** slow and sleepy.
- ◯ **C.** shy and quiet.
- ◯ **D.** quick and smart at solving problems.

Q5 RIT 201 Lexile 460L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Spider and the Stories"?

- ◯ **A.** Spiders can climb very high, all the way up a thread that reaches into the sky.
- ◯ **B.** A clever storyteller made sure the world's tales would be shared and told again and again.
- ◯ **C.** The Sky God laughed because he thought a tiny spider was far too small to win the stories.
- ◯ **D.** A box of stories can stay locked away in the sky until someone strong enough comes for it.

Passage 2 · Grandmother's Stories

Every summer, Mateo visited his grandmother in the mountains. After dinner, she would sit by the fire and tell old family stories. She told about his great-grandfather, who walked many miles to plant the first apple tree on their land. She told about the winter the river froze and the whole village skated on it. Mateo had heard the stories many times, but he never grew tired of them. One night his grandmother grew quiet. "Soon you must learn these tales by heart," she said. "When I am gone, you will be the one to tell them." Mateo felt proud and a little nervous. He began to listen even more closely. He asked questions and remembered every detail. Now, years later, Mateo tells the same stories to his own children by the fire. The tales did not end with his grandmother. They live on, passed from one person to the next.

151 WORDS · LEXILE 470–530L · RIT 202–207

Q6 RIT 202 Lexile 470L Key Detail

When did Mateo's grandmother tell her stories?

- ◯ **A.** Early in the morning before breakfast.
- ◯ **B.** After dinner, sitting by the fire.
- ◯ **C.** While walking to school.
- ◯ **D.** Only on his birthday.

Q7 RIT 204 Lexile 490L Key Detail

What did the great-grandfather do in one of the stories?

- ◯ **A.** He built a bridge over the river.
- ◯ **B.** He sailed across the ocean.
- ◯ **C.** He taught at the village school.
- ◯ **D.** He walked many miles to plant the first apple tree on their land.

Q8 RIT 205 · Lexile 500L · Cause & Effect

Why did Mateo begin to listen even more closely?

- **A.** His grandmother told him that one day he would be the one to tell the tales.
- **B.** He wanted to fall asleep faster.
- **C.** The fire was too warm.
- **D.** He could not hear her very well.

Q9 RIT 206 · Lexile 510L · Inference

When Mateo "asked questions and remembered every detail," it suggests that he —

- **A.** was bored by the stories.
- **B.** wanted his grandmother to stop.
- **C.** took the job of keeping the stories alive seriously.
- **D.** had already forgotten the tales.

Q10 RIT 207 · Lexile 530L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Grandmother's Stories"?

- **A.** Apple trees grow well in the mountains once someone walks many miles to plant the first one.
- **B.** Family stories live on when they are passed from one person, or generation, to the next.
- **C.** Rivers can freeze so hard in the winter that a whole village is able to skate on the ice.
- **D.** Summer is the best season of the year for a boy to visit his grandmother in the mountains.

Passage 3 · Why the Bear Has a Short Tail

Long ago, Bear had a long, beautiful tail, and he was very proud of it. One cold day, he met Fox sitting by a hole in the ice with a row of fish beside him. "How did you catch so many fish?" Bear asked. Fox was sly. "It is easy," he said. "Just drop your tail through the hole and wait. The fish will grab on. The longer you wait, the more you will catch." Bear lowered his long tail into the icy water and waited. He waited all night long. The water froze hard around his tail, but Bear thought he was simply catching many fish. When morning came, Bear jumped up to pull out his great catch. Snap! His frozen tail broke off, leaving only a short stub. From that day on, every bear has a short tail. And bears have never trusted a fox again. People still tell this tale to explain why bears look the way they do.

162 WORDS · LEXILE 540–600L · RIT 208–212

Q11 RIT 208 · Lexile 540L · Key Detail

What was Bear proud of at the start of the tale?

- **A.** His sharp teeth.
- **B.** His warm fur coat.
- **C.** His long, beautiful tail.
- **D.** His big, strong paws.

Q12 RIT 209 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

What did Fox tell Bear to do to catch fish?

- ◯ **A.** Drop his tail through the hole in the ice and wait.
- ◯ **B.** Dive into the cold water and swim.
- ◯ **C.** Use a net made of branches.
- ◯ **D.** Build a small fire on the ice.

Q13 RIT 210 · Lexile 570L · Cause & Effect

Why did Bear's tail break off?

- ◯ **A.** A fish pulled too hard on it.
- ◯ **B.** Fox cut it off with a knife.
- ◯ **C.** Bear sat on it by mistake.
- ◯ **D.** The water froze hard around it, and it snapped when Bear jumped up.

Q14 RIT 211 · Lexile 580L · Inference

The story says Fox was "sly." This is a clue that Fox —

- ◯ **A.** truly wanted to help Bear catch fish.
- ◯ **B.** was tricking Bear on purpose.
- ◯ **C.** was afraid of the cold.
- ◯ **D.** could not catch any fish himself.

Q15 RIT 212 · Lexile 600L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Why the Bear Has a Short Tail"?

- ◯ **A.** Foxes are good at fishing and can catch a whole row of fish beside a hole in the ice.
- ◯ **B.** Ice is dangerous in winter because the water can freeze hard around whatever is left in it.
- ◯ **C.** Bears were once very proud of having long, beautiful tails that they liked to show off.
- ◯ **D.** A folktale can explain why an animal looks the way it does and warn against being fooled.

Passage 4 · The Tale That Crossed the Sea

Many people know a story about a clever girl who loses a shoe and meets a prince. We often call it Cinderella. But this tale did not begin in one place. Long ago, a version of it was told in China, where a kind girl with tiny golden slippers was helped by a magic fish. Another version came from Egypt, about a girl whose sandal was carried away by a great bird. As traders and travelers moved from land to land, they carried their favorite tales with them. In each new place, storytellers changed small parts to fit their own world. The shoe might be glass, gold, or fur. The helper might be a fairy, a fish, or a bird. Yet the heart of the story stayed the same. Today there are hundreds of versions all over the world. One tale, told and retold across many lands, shows how stories travel and grow as they pass from one people to another.

161 WORDS · LEXILE 610–680L · RIT 213–215

Q16 RIT 213 | Lexile 610L | Key Detail

In the Chinese version of the tale, who helped the kind girl?

- **A.** A magic fish.
- **B.** A talking horse.
- **C.** A wise old king.
- **D.** A friendly dragon.

Q17 RIT 214 | Lexile 630L | Key Detail

How did the tale travel from one land to another?

- **A.** It was printed in newspapers.
- **B.** It was sent through the mail.
- **C.** Traders and travelers carried their favorite tales with them.
- **D.** It was taught only in schools.

Q18 RIT 214 | Lexile 650L | Vocabulary

The passage says there are many "versions" of the tale. A **version** is —

- **A.** the very first copy ever made.
- **B.** one form of a story that is a little different from the others.
- **C.** a true report with no changes.
- **D.** a kind of shoe worn long ago.

Q19 RIT 215 | Lexile 670L | Cause & Effect

Why did the details of the tale change from place to place?

- **A.** The story was forgotten and made up again.
- **B.** Each land had the very same world.
- **C.** No one liked the original ending.
- **D.** Storytellers changed small parts to fit their own world.

Q20 RIT 215 | Lexile 680L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Tale That Crossed the Sea"?

- **A.** In the story most people know, a clever girl loses a shoe and meets a prince.
- **B.** Long ago, versions of the tale were already being told in faraway lands like China and Egypt.
- **C.** One story, told and retold across many lands, shows how tales travel and grow as they pass from people to people.
- **D.** In the Egyptian version, a great bird carried the girl's sandal far away from her.